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Systems, Apparatuses, and Methods for Pulse Shaping in High Voltage Power Systems

Abstract

A high voltage pulse power delivery system is provided that includes dedicated safety features including fault detection and fault management. Alongside normal communications cabling, the pulse power delivery system provides remote power over standard multi-conductor cabling without dedicated conduit or separation. This simplifies installation of equipment, increases overall speed of deployment, and significantly reduces cost for deployment. The pulse power delivery system is further configured to transport power through a pulse current waveform.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION(S) [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. Non-Provisional patent application Ser. No. 18/197,418, filed May 15, 2023, which claims benefit to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/344,920, filed May 23, 2022, the entirety of which is incorporated by reference herein.

FIELD OF TECHNOLOGY

[0002] The present disclosure describes systems and methods relating to the technological field of high voltage power supply and safe power management and utilization for such high voltage power systems. The high voltage power systems may, for example, be in the field of Class 4 Fault Managed Power Distribution Systems, as described in more detail herein.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Effective power delivery systems for controlled environments (e.g., networked equipment within a building) are becoming more common. However, the designs and capabilities of existing power delivery systems are often times inadequate for their desired use. For example, they may not be able to provide adequate power, or they may not be able to effectively reach remote locations.

[0004] Furthermore, the existing systems have high equipment and installation costs, while also oftentimes being non-compliant with power or safety requirements and being non-durable.

SUMMARY

[0005] A pulser device included in a fault managed power delivery system is described, the pulser device comprising a signal shaping component configured to: generate a pulse power signal by pulsing a power signal according to a periodic pulsing scheme, wherein a pulse in the pulse power signal comprises: a first signal smoothing portion generated at a rising edge of a pulse in the pulse power signal; and a power delivery portion generated following the first signal smoothing portion.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

[0006] FIG. 1 illustrates a block diagram of an exemplary pulse power delivery system, according to some embodiments.

[0007] FIG. 2 illustrates a product-level diagram showing exemplary components that may be included in the pulse power delivery system shown in FIG. 1, according to some embodiments.

[0008] FIG. 3 illustrates a chart mapping an exemplary voltage on-off cycle that may be implemented in the pulse power delivery system, according to some embodiments.

[0009] FIG. 4A illustrates a circuit diagram of an exemplary safety detection circuit that may be included in the pulse power delivery system, according to some embodiments.

[0010] FIG. 4B illustrates a flow chart describing an exemplary fault detection and safety procedure using the safety detection circuit shown in FIG. 4A, according to some embodiments.

[0011] FIG. 5A illustrates an exemplary circuit diagram of the pulse power delivery system, according to some embodiments.

[0012] FIG. 5B illustrates a flow chart describing an exemplary circuit operation procedure that

may be implemented during a power delivery process using the circuits from the pulse power delivery system shown in FIG. 5A, according to some embodiments.

[0013] FIG. 6 illustrates voltage level graphs depicting different exemplary safety conditions that may occur while operating the pulse power delivery system, according to some embodiments.

[0014] FIG. 7 illustrates an exemplary circuit diagram of the pulse power delivery system, according to some embodiments.

[0015] FIG. 8 illustrates a voltage graph depicting certain exemplary voltage characteristics that may occur while operating the pulse power delivery system, according to some embodiments.

[0016] FIG. 9 illustrates an exemplary circuit diagram that may be included in the pulse power delivery system for clock recovery, ramp generation, cascaded and energy limited current source, according to some embodiments.

[0017] FIG. 10 illustrates a circuit diagram of an exemplary circuit that may be included in the pulse power delivery system for detecting fault conditions, according to some embodiments.

[0018] FIG. 11 illustrates a circuit diagram of an exemplary circuit that may be included in the pulse power delivery system for detecting a length of signal periods that may indicate a fault condition, according to some embodiments.

[0019] FIG. 12 illustrates a circuit diagram of an exemplary circuit that may be included in the pulse power delivery system for detecting voltage levels, according to some embodiments.

[0020] FIG. 13 illustrates a circuit diagram of an exemplary circuit that may be included in the pulse power delivery system for detecting a spurious voltage that may indicate a fault condition, according to some embodiments.

[0021] FIG. 14 illustrates a circuit diagram of an exemplary circuit that may be included in the pulse power delivery system for routing detected fault signals within the pulse power delivery system, according to some embodiments.

[0022] FIG. 15 illustrates an exemplary system diagram and exemplary pulse power signal that may be generated by the pulse power delivery system, according to some embodiments.

[0023] FIG. 16 illustrates an exemplary system diagram of a switching control system that may be utilized in the pulse power delivery system, according to some embodiments.

[0024] FIG. 17A illustrates an exemplary system diagram of a switching control system that may be utilized in the pulse power delivery system for applying a signal shaping solution to address signal defects, as well as an exemplary signal diagram of a corrected pulse power signal, according to some embodiments.

[0025] FIG. 17B illustrates an exemplary flow diagram of a signal shaping solution implemented on a pulse power signal by the switching control system shown in FIG. 17A, according to some embodiments.

[0026] FIG. 18 illustrates an exemplary system diagram of the pulse power delivery system in a line-to-line topology, according to some embodiments.

[0027] FIG. 19 illustrates an exemplary system diagram of the pulse power delivery system in a daisy-chain topology, according to some embodiments.

[0028] FIG. 20 illustrates an exemplary system diagram of the pulse power delivery system in a combination topology where the outputs from multiple pulse power converters are combined, according to some embodiments.

[0029] FIG. 21 illustrates an exemplary system diagram of the pulse power delivery system showing RF communication link components that are involved when a single pulser module is coupled to a single pulse power converter, according to some embodiments.

[0030] FIG. 22 illustrates an exemplary system diagram of an RF communication unit included in the pulser module as well as the pulse power converter shown in FIG. 21, according to some embodiments.

[0031] FIG. 23 illustrates an exemplary data packet structure and an exemplary timing graph for transmitting the data packet structure, according to some embodiments.

[0032] FIG. **24** illustrates a timing graph describing an exemplary synchronization strategy when operating three pulser modules, according to some embodiments.

[0033] FIG. **25** illustrates a timing graph describing an exemplary synchronization strategy when operating nine pulser modules, according to some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0034] The methods, devices, systems, and other features discussed below may be embodied in a number of different forms. Not all of the depicted components may be required, however, and some implementations may include additional, different, or fewer components from those expressly described in this disclosure. Variations in the arrangement and type of the components may be made without departing from the spirit or scope of the solution as set forth herein. Further, variations in the processes described, including the addition, deletion, or rearranging an order of operations, may be made without departing from the spirit or scope of the solution as set forth herein.

[0035] This disclosure describes embodiments of a pulse power delivery system that includes dedicated safety features including fault detection and fault management. Wireless systems are installed in a variety of locations and venues. An exemplary pulse power delivery system provides a remote power delivery solution that helps wireless system integrators design and deploy wireless systems. This solution may be ideal for larger venues or complex installations that require centralized power that is cost efficient, safe, easy to install, and can reach further distances. In this way, the pulse power delivery system may be configured to remotely power electrical devices such as remote radios, small cells, security cameras, access controls, as well as indoor and outdoor Distributed Antenna Systems (DAS).

[0036] Easy to install and designed for wireless solutions, the pulse power delivery system uses wiring methods afforded to communications wiring per NEC (National Electrical Code) guidelines. Alongside normal communications cabling, the pulse power delivery system may provide remote power over standard multi-conductor cabling without dedicated conduit or separation. This simplifies installation of equipment, increases overall speed of deployment, and significantly reduces cost for deployment. The pulse power delivery system is further configured to transport power through a pulse current waveform (note, the pulse power signal may alternatively be referenced as a pulse current signal). The pulse power delivery system also includes a fault prevention method that further improves its safety characteristics, as will be described in more detail herein.

[0037] FIG. **1** illustrates a simplified system diagram that shows device components that may be included in an exemplary pulse power delivery system **100**. A pulse power source **110** is configured to receive standard AC power (e.g., 110/220V outlets or 208V source from a rack-PDU), then the pulse power source **110** converts the received standard AC power into a higher voltage, limited current, DC power (e.g., 360 V, up to 400V, or higher voltage according to some embodiments). From the pulse power source **110**, power is transmitted in a pulse current waveform, through a multi-conductor cable power transmission line **102**, to be received by the pulse power converter **120**. The pulse power converter **120** is configured to convert the received pulse power into end-device usable power (e.g., 48V DC power). The pulse power converter **120** is typically distributed throughout a building near one or more end-device loads that require the power for operation.

[0038] FIG. **2** illustrates a more detailed system diagram showing exemplary device components in the pulse power source **110** and how it communicates with the pulse power converter **120** in the pulse power delivery system **100**. As shown in FIG. **2**, the pulse power source **110** may include a chassis for holding one or more power supply modules **111**, one or more pulser modules **112**, and one or more management cards **115**. The management card **115** may include a processor, as well as software, hardware, middleware, and/or circuitry for implementing any one or more of the features described herein.

[0039] A rear side of the pulse power source **110** includes one or more openings **113** (e.g., three

openings) for installing a respective power supply module **111**, and a front side of the pulse power source **110** includes one or more openings **114** (e.g., nine openings) for installing a respective pulser module **112**. The front side also includes an opening for installing the management card **115**. Within the pulse power source **110**, the power supply module **111** is configured to receive standard AC power, convert it into the higher voltage, and then transmit it to the pulser modules **112**, where the pulser modules **112** are configured to pulse this high voltage power according to a pulsing scheme, and transmit it across the transmission line **102** to the pulse power converter **120**.

[0040] After receiving the high voltage pulse power, the pulse power converter **120** is configured to convert this down into a device usable voltage (e.g., 48V DC power) and deliver it to one or more end-devices. The pulser module **112** is coupled to the transmission line **102** to monitor the voltage/power being transmitted over the transmission line, where the pulser module **112** is configured to control one or more of the fault management safety features of the pulse power delivery system **100** described herein.

[0041] The pulse power delivery system **100** may, for example, be an implementation of an NEC Class 4 power distribution system capable of supplying up to 400V for a limited period (e.g., ON-TIME period) followed by a period of time (e.g., OFF-TIME) where a much-reduced voltage is supplied. The reduced voltage that is supplied during this OFF-TIME may be a predetermined voltage (e.g., less than around 60V) with a limited current capability. The ON-TIME period and OFF-TIME period are typically in the range of milliseconds, where the ON-TIME period may be greater than the OFF-TIME period (e.g., 2 ms ON-TIME, 1 ms OFF-TIME), the ON-TIME period may be less than the OFF-TIME period (e.g., 1 ms ON-TIME, 2 ms OFF-TIME), or the ON-TIME period may be substantially the same as the OFF-TIME period (e.g., 2 ms ON-TIME, 2 ms OFF-TIME).

[0042] The OFF-TIME period may be utilized to determine an un-safe situation in the pulse power delivery system. In the case where an un-safe condition is detected, the circuit will prevent turning on the power to the line. For example, FIG. 3 shows a voltage chart **300** depicting an exemplary voltage value for a pulse power signal being transmitted over time by the pulser module **112** via the transmission line **102**, where this pulse power signal is being received by the pulse power converter **120**. In the voltage chart **300** shown in FIG. 3, the ON-TIME during which the voltage is ON (e.g., $V_{sub.ON}$) is longer than the OFF-TIME where the voltage is OFF (e.g., $V_{sub.OFF}$). However, according to other embodiments the ON-TIME where the voltage is ON (e.g., $V_{sub.ON}$) may be the same, or shorter, than the OFF-TIME where the voltage is OFF (e.g., $V_{sub.OFF}$).

[0043] To implement the safety fault detection in the pulse power delivery system **100**, a safety circuitry is included. For example, FIG. 4A shows an exemplary system diagram of a safety circuitry **400** that may be included in the pulser module **112**. The safety circuitry **400** is configured to include both a detection circuit and a prevention circuit, where the detection circuit and the prevention circuit are separate and independent from each other. Keeping these two circuits independent helps improve the reliability (e.g., the Functional Safety Failure in Time (FIT) rate) of the safety circuitry **400** and also ensures a fail-safe operation of the safety circuitry **400**.

Furthermore, to improve the FIT rate of the safety circuitry **400** the only inputs to the safety circuitry **400** are the transmission line. The safety circuitry **400** is further designed to utilize discrete components (e.g., no programmable devices used) to improve its reliability.

[0044] The safety circuitry **400** includes a high-voltage DC input **410** generated by a power supply module **111**. The safety circuitry **400** also includes an output terminal **420** that is coupled to the transmission line **102**. The safety circuitry **400** also includes a first switch **401** (e.g., current profile switch) that is coupled to a first logic/control circuitry **403** and a first safety sense circuitry **405**. The safety circuitry **400** also includes a second switch **402** (e.g., power switch) that is coupled to a second logic/control circuitry **404** and a second safety sense circuitry **406**.

[0045] FIG. 4B shows a flow chart **450** describing an exemplary fault detection process that may be implemented by the pulser module **112** using the safety circuitry **400**. At **451**, a fault may be

detected. The fault detection **451** may occur during a start-up initialization step of the pulse power delivery system **100**. In addition, or alternatively, the fault detection **451** may occur following some normal operational time of the pulse power delivery system **100**. The fault detection **451** may correspond to a fault condition that includes, for example but not limited to, a person touching the transmission line **102**, a load that was receiving the pulse power being disconnected during pulse power transmission, an over voltage condition being detected, an ON-TIME period being detected to being too long, an OFF-TIME period being detected to being too short, and/or spurious ON voltage sensing (e.g., detection of a voltage turning on at the output terminals not as a result of the control system intentionally turning on).

[0046] At **452**, the power path is disconnected by turning off the first switch **401**.

[0047] At **453**, the power path is disconnected by turning off the second switch **402**.

[0048] At **454**, the disconnected power paths are maintained by keeping the first switch **401** and the second switch **402** open (i.e., turned off) for a predetermined length of time following the detection of the fault condition. For example, the predetermined time may be a minimum of at least 5 seconds.

[0049] Following the predetermined length of time, the power path may be reestablished.

Alternatively, according to some embodiments an additional verification step may be implemented before the power path is reestablished.

[0050] FIG. 5A shows an exemplary system diagram that includes components of a pulse power delivery system **500** including a safety detection circuit **512**, according to some embodiments. The pulse power delivery system **500** includes a pulse power pulser module **510**, a pulse power converter module **520**, and a transmission line **102** connecting the two system components. In FIG. 5A, the component devices included in the pulse power delivery system **500** may be a system architecture representation of the same components shown to be included in the pulse power delivery system **100**.

[0051] The pulse power pulser module **510** includes a safety detection circuit **512**, where the safety detection circuit **512** may be a higher level system representation of certain components of the safety circuitry **400** shown in FIG. 4A. The safety detection circuit **512** includes a circuitry component **518** (e.g., a Zener diode or window voltage comparator), where the safety detection circuit **512** may be configured to detect a change in voltage across the transmission line **102** and/or detect a change to the characteristic impedance of the transmission line **102**.

[0052] The pulse power pulser module **510** further includes a first switch **514** (e.g., the first switch **514** may be a representation of the first switch **401** and the second switch **402** included in the safety circuitry **400** shown in FIG. 4A), a current source **513** that is connected in parallel to the switch **514**, a second switch **516**, a circuitry component **517** (e.g., Zener diode or window voltage comparator), and the safety detection circuit **512**. The second switch **516** and the circuitry component **517** together make up a discharger circuit **511**. The discharger circuit **511** discharges the transmission line **102** to a safe voltage during the OFF-TIME, during which the transmission line **102** is checked for any faults. The safe voltage on the transmission line **102** during the OFF-TIME is regulated by the current source **513** and the load detection circuit **521** included in the pulse power converter module **520**, as described in more detail below.

[0053] Included in the pulse power converter module **520**, a current source **525** and a circuitry component **526** (e.g., Zener diode or window voltage comparator) together make up a load detection circuit **521**. The load detection circuit **521** provides a constant current drop on the transmission line **102** during the OFF-TIME. If the pulse power converter module **520** is not connected to the transmission line **102**, the voltage will not be regulated to a pre-define threshold. In this case, the pulse power pulser module **510** will not detect the pulse power converter module **520** during initialization or will detect a disconnected state for the pulse power converter module **520** during a normal operation. In both cases, the load detection circuit **521** will disconnect the high voltage and put the transmission line **102** into a safe state until the pulse power converter module

520 is detected.

[0054] The voltage on the transmission line **102** during initialization or the OFF-TIME is regulated by the current source **513** (on the pulse power pulser module **510**) and the load detection circuit **521** (on the pulse power converter module **520**). The load detection circuit **521** regulates the transmission line **102** to a safe voltage by either dynamically changing the load resistor or by using the circuitry component **526**. The load detection circuit **521** is coupled to a diode **524**, and is further in parallel to a capacitor **522**, which is in parallel to a load device **523**, where the load device **523** is the end device configured to receive the pulse power in the pulse power delivery system **500**. The combination of the capacitor **522** and the diode **524** serves as a pulse rectifier, which provides the DC Bus voltage to the load.

[0055] FIG. **5B** shows a flow chart **550** describing an exemplary circuit operation procedure during a power delivery process, where the power is being transmitted according to a process controlled by the pulser module **112** using the safety detection circuit **512**.

[0056] At **551**, the first switch **514** closes at the beginning of an ON-TIME period to provide power from the power supply **515**. This power is supplied to the load device **523** through the diode **524**.

[0057] At **552**, the first switch **514** opens at the end of the ON-TIME period, effectively shutting down the power being transmitted over the transmission line **102**. The diode **524** operates to block a reverse DC current from feeding back to the transmission line **102** from the capacitor **522** on the side of the pulse power converter module **520**.

[0058] At **553**, the second switch **516** in the discharger circuit **511** is closed for a predetermined length of time (e.g., a short amount of time that may, for example, be determined by the maximum capacity of the transmission line **102**). By closing the second switch **516**, this reduces the residual voltage on the transmission line **102** to a safe voltage level defined by the reference voltage across the circuitry component **517** in the discharger circuit **511**.

[0059] At **554**, the current source **513** supplies a low current to the transmission line **102**. The low current may be, for example, 2 mA. Alternatively, according to some embodiments the low current may be lower than 2 mA, slightly greater than 2 mA, or within a range of predetermined low currents. The current source **525** included in the load detection circuit **521** provides a path to hold/regulate the residual line voltage to a value defined by the circuitry component **526** in the load detection circuit **521**. According to a first example, the load detection circuit **521** implements a current sink as a load that draws current from the transmission line **102** as long as the voltage is above the value defined by the circuitry component **526** to keep the line voltage around the voltage value of the circuitry component **526**. According to a second example, the load detection circuit **521** implements a controlled current sink as a load and an analog window comparator that compares the line voltage to a reference voltage and switches the controlled current sink to maintain the line voltage within a predetermined window.

[0060] FIG. **6** shows three exemplary graphs **610**, **620**, **630** that portray three different scenarios that may occur on the transmission line **102** and be handled by the safety detection circuit **512**.

[0061] The first graph **610** portrays a normal condition where at the end of the OFF-TIME period the line voltage detected on the transmission line **102** should be around the voltage set across circuitry component **526** (e.g., Zener diode).

[0062] The second graph **620** portrays a disconnected condition where at the end of the OFF-TIME period the line voltage detected on the transmission line **102** will be higher than the voltage across circuitry component **517** (e.g., Zener diode or window voltage comparator).

[0063] The third graph **630** portrays an unsafe condition where at the end of the OFF-TIME period the line voltage detected on the transmission line **102** will be lower than the voltage across circuitry component **518** (e.g., Zener diode or window voltage comparator).

[0064] FIG. **7** shows an exemplary system diagram for a pulse power delivery system **500-1**, where the components in the pulse power deliver system **500-1** are the same as shown for pulse power deliver system **500**, except for a number of parasitic capacitance elements **530** that are found on the

transmission line **102** in the embodiments described by the pulse power deliver system **500-1**. The parasitic capacitance elements **530** are represented by capacitors but may be representative of other circuitry components that impart parasitic capacitance characteristics in other embodiments. [0065] The parasitic capacitance elements **530** are shown to be representative of undesirable elements that may be found on the transmission line **102** in the pulse power delivery system **500-1**, and also provide an opportunity to describe how such undesirable elements may be addressed by the safety detection circuit **512** in the pulse power delivery system **500-1**. In essence, the pulse power delivery system **500-1** is designed so that the parasitic capacitance elements **530** do not change operation of the safety detection circuit **512**.

[0066] For example, FIG. **8** shows a voltage graph **800** that includes a first voltage plot **801** and a second voltage plot **802**. The first voltage plot **801** depicts the voltage characteristics for a first transmission line having a high parasitic capacitance, while the second voltage plot **802** depicts the voltage characteristics for a second transmission line having a low parasitic capacitance.

[0067] In the first voltage plot **801** representing the first transmission line with high parasitic capacitance, under normal conditions the voltage is seen to drop slightly below the discharge voltage, $V_{sub.discharge}$, then under unsafe conditions the voltage is seen to drop noticeably below the discharge voltage $V_{sub.discharge}$, and under the condition where the pulse power converter module **520** is disconnected (i.e., another type of fault condition) the voltage is seen to rise slightly above the discharge voltage $V_{sub.discharge}$. In the second voltage plot **802** representing the second transmission line with low parasitic capacitance, under normal conditions the voltage is seen to drop noticeably below the discharge voltage, $V_{sub.discharge}$, then under unsafe conditions the voltage is seen to drop significantly below the discharge voltage $V_{sub.discharge}$ to a level marked as $-V/2$, and under the condition where the pulse power converter module **520** is disconnected (i.e., another type of fault condition) the voltage is seen to rise noticeably above the discharge voltage $V_{sub.discharge}$ to a level marked as a surge voltage $V_{sub.surge}$. It follows that the pulse power delivery system **500** is able to establish the threshold limits in a way that parasitic capacitance found on the transmission line **102** will not change the operation of the safety detection mechanisms of the safety detection circuit **512**. The voltage threshold limits are set, for example, by the discharge levels defined by the circuitry component **517** and the current source **513** and the window voltage comparator in the circuitry component **526**.

[0068] For purposes of this disclosure, the following definitions may be used:

[0069] “Touch”—detection of voltage drops below a defined threshold during the OFF-Time period.

[0070] “Disconnected”—detection of voltage increases above a defined threshold during the OFF-Time period.

[0071] “Over Voltage”—detection of excessive voltage across the output terminals during the ON Time period.

[0072] “ON Timing”—detection of the ON-Time period sensed across the output terminals is determined to be too long.

[0073] “OFF Timing”—detection of the OFF-Time period sensed across the output terminals is determined to be too short or too long.

[0074] “ON sense”—detection of a voltage turning on at the output terminals that is not caused by the control system turning on.

[0075] FIGS. **9-13** illustrate exemplary circuit diagrams that may be included in the pulser modules **112** for generating some of the critical signals that are used during operation. These signals are generated from relying on output line statuses and will be used in various parts of the safety detection circuit **512**.

[0076] FIG. **9** illustrates an exemplary circuit diagram of a circuit **900** that may be included in the pulser modules **112**. The circuit **900** includes component and/or mechanisms for preventing a single component failure from causing an un-safe condition that may be included in the pulser modules

112.

[0077] The circuit **900** includes a first current source **901** and a second current source **902**, where the first current source **901** and the second current source **902** are configured in a two-stage, cascaded, configuration to prevent a single component failure from causing an un-safe condition. Each of the first current source **901** and the second current source **902** may be 2 mA current sources. The first current source **901** is coupled to an input to a DC bus **903**, and an output to the second current source **902** is coupled to a terminal block **904** as well as to a series of circuit components including an voltage conditioning and sensing component **905**, a pulse regeneration component **906**, a sawtooth generator component **907**, and an end of OFF-TIME clock generator component **908**. Each of the first current source **901** or the second current source **902** may be disabled from providing current, that is controlled by the independent safety detection circuits in the pulser module **112**.

[0078] Specifically, the voltage conditioning and sensing component **905** is configured to convert the Line high voltage to voltage levels compatible with electronic logic components (e.g., sensing components).

[0079] The pulse regeneration component **906** together with the sawtooth generator component **907** work as comparator circuits and are configured to re-create the ON-TIME switching signal (OT_CLOCK) and the ON-TIME Ramping Signal (ON_RAMP) from the transmission line.

[0080] The end of OFF-TIME clock generator component **908** is configured to generate a pulse EOF_CLK at the end of the OFF-TIME period which is used by fault detection logic latches **1003** and **1005** (shown in FIG. **10**).

[0081] FIG. **10** illustrates an exemplary circuit diagram of a circuit **1000** that may be included in the pulser modules **112**. The circuit **1000** includes components and/or mechanisms that are utilized to detect unsafe conditions and generate a detection signal when a “Touch” or a “Disconnected” scenario is detected on the transmission line **102**.

[0082] The circuit **1000** includes an off-voltage sensing component **1001** that includes a dedicated voltage divider block for converting the line high voltage to voltage levels compatible with electronic logic components. This off-voltage sensing component **1001** is utilized to aid in a fault detection operation during the OFF-TIME of the pulse power being transmitted on the transmission line **102**. This off-voltage sensing component **1001** also expands the OFF-TIME voltage and “clips off” the ON TIME voltages.

[0083] The circuit **1000** includes a touch threshold comparator **1002** configured to compare this off-transition sensing voltage from the off-voltage sensing component **1001** to a predetermined threshold, $V_{sub.T}$. The output from the touch threshold comparator **1002** is a logic level “high” when the input is above the threshold $V_{sub.T}$. The output is coupled to a logic latch **1003**, such that at the end of the OFF-TIME the logic latch **1003** creates a logic level “low” latched signal if the transmission line **102** is in an unsafe condition, e.g., line touch detected. The circuit **1000** is held at a logic level “high” (i.e., safe) when the line voltage is below a predetermined Safe to touch voltage level (e.g., sag 60V) as detected by the VMINOK signal (e.g., Voltage Minimum OK is equivalent to 60V).

[0084] The circuit **1000** includes a disconnect threshold comparator **1004** configured to compare the off-transition sensing voltage from the off-voltage sensing component **1001** to a predefined threshold, $V_{sub.C}$. The output from the disconnect threshold comparator **1004** will be a logic ‘low’ when the input voltage is above the $V_{sub.C}$, and a logic ‘high’ when the input voltage is below $V_{sub.C}$. The output from the disconnect threshold comparator **1004** is then latched at the end of the OFF-TIME by a logic latch **1005**. If the transmission line **102** is detected to being disconnected from the load (Converter), the latch output will be held at a logic “low” (i.e., not ready/disconnected). Otherwise, the latch output will be held at a logic “high” (ready/connected). Therefore, the circuit **1000** is held at a logic “high” level (i.e., safe) when the Line voltage is below safe to touch (e.g., sag 60V) as detected by the VMINOK signal.

[0085] FIG. **11** illustrates an exemplary circuit diagram of circuit **1100** that may be included in the pulser modules **112**. The circuit **1100** includes components and/or mechanisms utilized to generate a signal that indicates when the ON-TIME is too long at the end of one period that is used in different parts of the safety detection circuit. While the described embodiments are described as measuring both the ON-TIME and OFF-TIME as a periods, other embodiments where a period is measured from ON-TIME to subsequent ON-TIME (e.g., measured from rising edge of ON-TIME to rising edge of subsequent ON-TIME) are also considered.

[0086] The circuit **1100** includes a saw tooth generator **1101** that is triggered by the End of OFF TIME Clock Generator and configured to discharge an RC circuit at the end of the OFF-TIME period. The voltage level of the output from the saw tooth generator **1101** reflects the time into the total period. The circuit **1100** also includes a Period exceeds max threshold detector **1103** configured to transition to a “Low” logic level when the Period is too short (e.g., an issue in the system clock causing a longer pulse period).

[0087] The circuit **1100** also includes an ON-TIME exceeds max threshold detector **1105** that is triggered by a Ramp signal generated by the ON-Time RC circuit. The detector **1105** is configured to transition to a “high” logic level when the input voltage exceeds a predefined threshold, $V_{sub.T}$, which corresponds to an excessive ON-TIME duration. An output of the detector **1105** is coupled to a logic latch **1106**, where the logic latch **1106** is configured to hold the logic latch **1106** at the “high” logic level (i.e., safe) when the Line voltage is below 60V as detected by the VMINOK signal. The detection may represent an over voltage condition on transmission line **102** due to the possibility of an increased duty cycle. In all cases the detection represents a system timing error, in which case the logic latch **1106** may be configured to hold the circuit **1100** at the “low” logic level (i.e., fault detected).

[0088] The circuit **1100** also includes an End of ON-TIME Clock Generator **1104** configured to create a positive edge at near the end of the ON-TIME period.

[0089] FIG. **12** illustrates an exemplary circuit diagram of a circuit **1200** that includes components and/or mechanisms utilized to generate a signal that indicates when a line voltage exit maximum allowed voltage is present on the line and a signal that indicates line voltage is exiting safe to touch voltage (e.g., 60V). This circuit **1200** may be used in different parts of the safety detection circuit included in the pulse power delivery system **100**.

[0090] The circuit **1200** includes an On/Off voltage Transition Sensing component **1201** that includes a dedicated voltage divider block configured to convert the line high voltage to voltage levels compatible with electronic logic components (e.g., 3.3V, or approximately 3.3V).

[0091] The circuit **1200** also includes an Over Voltage Detection component **1202** configured to go low when the line voltage is above a maximum allowed voltage (e.g., 385 V, or approximately 385 V). The output from the Over Voltage Detection component **1202** is latched to a logic latch **1204** at the end of the ON-TIME period to generate a logic “low” signal when this condition occurs. The circuit is held at a “high” logic level (i.e., safe) when the line voltage is below 60V as detected by the VMINOK signal.

[0092] The circuit also includes a High Voltage Detector component **1203** configured to go “high” when the Line voltage exceeds safe to touch voltage (e.g., sag 60V) to enable the safety detection circuitry. This circuit **1200** remains active during OFF-TIME periods that occur after an ON-TIME period that exceeds the safe to touch voltage (e.g, 60V).

[0093] FIG. **13** illustrates an exemplary circuit diagram of a circuit **1300** that may be included in the pulse power pulser module **112**.

[0094] The circuit **1300** includes a Matched IO (MIO_OK) detector latch **1301** that latches the level of the main timing PWM signal generated by the control system at the beginning of the ON TIME as detected from the transmission line **102**. If the main timing PWM signal is not high when transmission line **102** is detected as going high the output from the latch **1301** will go low, indicating a fault.

[0095] FIG. **14** illustrates an exemplary circuit diagram of a circuit **1400** including circuitry and the corresponding integrations of fault signals analyzed by the redundant circuits in the pulser module **112**.

[0096] As discussed, the pulser modules **112** may be configured to generate the following fault detection signals as shown in FIG. **14**: NO_TOUCH signal **1401**, CONNECT signal **1402**, VMAXOK signal **1403**, ON_OK signal **1404**, PERIOD_OK signal **1405**, and MIO_OK signal **1406**. One or more of these six fault detection signals will go low when an un-safe condition is detected. The un-safe condition forces the output of the latch **1410** to go low, which disables a respective Switch and transmit a “high” signal to the MCUs.

[0097] Each of the detection signals also go to the MCUs through their respective resistors **1421-1426** for error reporting. The resistors **1421-1426** are large enough that the MCU cannot alter the logic level presented at the inputs to the AND component **1411**. The activation of the latch **1410** starts a 3~5 second delay in a Fault Clear Logic **1412**. This output will clock the latch **1410** and if all the detection signals go “high” (i.e., in-active state) the fault condition will clear. While any detection signal is active, the fault condition will remain.

[0098] The circuit **1400** also includes a Power-On Delay component **1413** configured to block force a momentary clearing of the latch **1410** on power up. A Fault Reset Switch may also manually force a clear signal to the latch **1410**. The circuit **1400** also includes a delay end pulse component **1414** which is configured to convert the Power-On Delay signal into a pulse rather than a continuous logic high or low signal.

[0099] These described circuits are fully redundant, meaning they may be duplicated.

Signal Shaping

[0100] In the power electronics field, switching high voltage signals On and Off into power-transmission lines to control current or voltage may be applied in certain implementations of packet-based power transmission application (i.e., NEC Class 4 Power supply), which is the solutions offered by the pulse power delivery system **100**. Here the voltage is turned on and off in a certain fixed interval. The OFF-TIME may be used to detect the status of the power transmission line **102**.

[0101] The base rate of switching the power between the ON-TIME and the OFF-TIME may be in the low frequency range, however, depending on the period, the slope of the transition and amplitude of the switched voltage, there is the chance for the introduction of high frequency spectrum/harmonics. This phenomenon is best understood as a Fourier spectrum representation of a trapezoidal clock signal.

[0102] The power-transmission lines are often selected based on the rated current capacity and rated voltage level; hence, the impedance of cables is not necessarily matched with the High Frequency (HF) impedance of the source and HF impedance of the load. The HF impedance of the source and load are characterized as power source impedance and power load impedance at the transition time. If the HF impedance creates a mismatch with the power transmission line, it may generate reflections. As illustrated in the exemplary power system **1510** of FIG. **15**, a reflected signal in a power transmission line can travel back and forth many times between a power source **1511** and a powered sink **1512** (i.e., load) until it gets attenuated, which is an unwanted occurrence on the transmission line.

[0103] FIG. **15** also includes a corresponding exemplary pulse power signal **1520** that outlines the intended pulse signal in the dashed line and also superimposes the unwanted signal reflections that may actually result from the power system **1510** in the solid line. Reflections like this manifest themselves as ringing, standing waves and overshoot, as exemplified in the pulse power signal **1520**. This can result in high voltage spikes that can have damaging effects on the installed equipment and/or create EMI/EMC issues. As illustrated by the pulse power signal **1520**, the actual signal propagating on the power transmission line has ringing and overshoot at the transition times and defers from the intended (ideal) signal. The reflected signal's propagation time over the power

transmission line dictates the frequency content forming the ripple signal.

[0104] Being described herein is a signal smoothing solution that eliminates, or at least significantly reduces, this overshoot phenomenon and hence reduces the unwanted negative effects resulting from it. Although the signal smoothing solution is described as being applied to a pulse power signal produced by the pulse power delivery system **100**, it may be applied more generally to other systems and different applications, such as for example motor control, that may or may not utilize pulse power.

[0105] Reduction of the high frequency components of the switched signal and/or decreasing the switched signal's high order harmonics can be accomplished by the alteration of the switched signal's slope (e.g., rise and fall time) at the transition time. The concept is realized utilizing a pulsing control signal technique (see e.g., FIG. **17A**) to control the slope of the transition without additional power loss. This will be implemented by generating a much higher rate switching-control-signal with a varying duty cycle at the transition times combined with a smoothing circuit at the output of the switcher. The higher rate of the switching-control-signal can be implemented in terms of variable frequency with a varying duty cycle.

[0106] FIG. **16** illustrates an exemplary simplified system diagram of a switching control system **1600** for producing pulse power, where the switching control system generates a switching power signal that may result in a ripple and/or an overshoot (hereinafter may be referred to as signal defects) on the power transmission lines at the transition intervals. The switching control system **1600** includes a switching control component **1603** that is placed on a power transmission line **1602** being supplied by a DC voltage source **1601**. Also included in FIG. **16** is an exemplary control signal **1620** that demonstrates the timing of the control signal **1620** for controlling the opening and closing of the switching control component **1603**. Also included in FIG. **16** is an exemplary voltage power signal **1630** resulting from the switching control system **1600**, where the voltage power signal **1630** is shown to include the unwanted signal defects **1631**, **1632** at the pulse start (see signal defect **1631**) and the pulse down (see signal defect **1631**).

[0107] FIG. **17A** illustrates an exemplary system diagram of a switching control system **1700** that now includes a smoothing circuit **1704** according to the current solution. The smoothing circuit includes an inductor-capacitor (LC) filter comprised of an inductor **1704-1** and a capacitor **1704-2**, as well as a free-wheel diode **1704-3**. The switching control system **1700** includes a switching control component **1703** that is placed on a power transmission line **1702** being supplied by a DC voltage source **1701**. In addition to these power pulsing components, the switching control system **1700** additionally includes the smoothing circuit **1704** (i.e., High-voltage Integrator). Unlike the earlier described pulse power signal **1520** that was simply turned high then low for controlling the pulse power period, the smoothing circuit **1704** is configured to control the switching control signal **1720** so that the switching control signal **1720** itself is pulsed a number of times (e.g., a predetermined number of times) on the rise and fall of the switching control signal **1720**. This is implemented by pulsing the switching control component **1703** a number of times at the rising edge **1740** and pulsing the switching control component **1703** a number of times at the falling edge **1750**. This results in modulating or shaping the rising and failing edges/portion of the overall switching control signal **1720** that is the active power signal **1745** being shortened. For example, the overall switching control signal **1720** may be HIGH, or have an ON-TIME, for a temporal length of approximately 2 ms, with the rising edge **1740** being approximately 50 μ s and the falling edge being approximately 50 μ s of that time. Therefore, in this embodiment, the signal smoothing on the rising edge and falling edge comprises 5% or less of the overall pulse, with each being 2.5% or less of the overall pulse.

[0108] The length of time during which the pulses are implemented in the rising edge **1740** and/or the falling edge **1750** may be adjusted to be longer, or shorter (e.g., a predetermined length of time). For example, the time during which the pulses are implemented in the rising edge **1740** and/or the falling edge **1750** may be adjusted to a longer, or a shorter, amount of time (e.g., a

predetermined amount of time) based on external factors such as the known physical characteristics of the transmission line cable.

[0109] As seen in the magnified view of the rising edge **1740** portion in the switching control signal **1720**, the rising edge **1740** includes a number of individual pulses **1741-1744**. Although four pulses **1741-1744** are shown, in alternative embodiments the number of pulses may be greater, or fewer, than those shown in FIG. **17A**. Furthermore, each subsequent pulse **1741-1744** may be slightly longer in temporal length as shown in FIG. **17A**, or alternatively each pulse **1741-1744** may be equal in temporal length. The pulses in the falling edge **1750** may be reflective of the pulses in the rising edge **1740**. Although both the rising edge **1740** and the falling edge **1750** are shown to include pulses, according to some embodiments the pulses may only be included in one of the rising edge **1740** or the falling edge **1750**. Also, although the pulses in the rising edge **1740** are shown to last for approximately the same amount of time as the pulses in the falling edge **1750**, according to some embodiments the pulses may last for different amounts of time. For example, the rising edge **1740** may last for a period of time, or a number of pulses, that is less than, or greater than, a period of time, or a number of pulses, of the falling edge **1750**.

[0110] As shown by the voltage signal **1730** in FIG. **17A**, the voltage signal **1730** resulting from the signal shaping/smoothing solution has a much smoother rising edge, free of the ripple and/or an overshoot signal defects **1631** found in voltage power signal **1630**.

[0111] The different embodiments of the switching control signal **1720** being controlled by the smoothing circuit **1704** may be adjusted according to the known physical characteristics of the transmission line cable. It follows that the current solution of the smoothing circuit **1704** may detect a type of cable, including one or more cable attributes, and select a particular signal shaping solution to match the detected cable type. The cable type may be detected based on a load characteristic of the cable, and the selected signal shaping solution will be optimized for the particular type of load characteristic of the cable. The cable attributes may also be input by a user so that the pulser modules **112** determines the optimum signal shaping solution based on the cable attributes received.

[0112] FIG. **17B** shows an exemplary flow diagram **1760** describing a process for implementing the signal shaping solution described herein. The process may be implemented, for example, by the pulser module **112** included in the pulse power delivery system **100**.

[0113] At **1761**, cable attributes of the cable used as the transmission line **102** are gathered. The cable attributes may be gathered according to any of the methods described herein. For example, the cable attributes may be detected based on a load characteristic of the cable that can be determined following a load detection test conducted on the transmission line **102**. The cable attributes may be manually input to the pulse power delivery system **100**. The cable attributes may be looked-up from a database, where a user inputs the cable identification, and the pulse power delivery system **100** looks up the cable identification in a database storing cables and their respective attributes. Then when a match is found from the database, the corresponding cable attributes may be obtained. The cable attributes may include one or more of the following: characteristic impedance, capacitance, inductance, DC impedance, AC impedance, or other measurable cable attribute.

[0114] At **1762**, the pulser modules **112** may select a tailored signal shaping solution based on the cable attributes detected earlier. In this way, the signal shaping to the switching control signal may be adjusted to fit the particular cable being used as the transmission line **102**. The adjustments may be according to any one or more of the adjustments described herein. Alternatively, a default signal shaping may be chosen when cable attributes are not specifically detected, or when the default signal shaping is selected to be applied.

[0115] At **1763**, the switching control signal selected from earlier at step **1762** is generated and applied to the switching control component in the pulse power delivery system **100**.

RF Data Link Over a High-Voltage Pair of Conductors

[0116] Pulse Current (i.e., Fault managed power distribution) is a method for transmitting and delivering high power (e.g., Class 4) in a more efficient and safe manner, where power is instantaneously turned off in case of fault (e.g., cable distribution). Pulse current (PC) is a direct current that is non-contiguous, where the direct current is chopped up into ON/OFF intervals and a fault condition is tested in each interval before the other pulse can be transmitted. PC power may be transmitted over a pair of copper conductors, same as in DC power. When a fault is detected on the transmission line, a pulse power delivery system (e.g., the pulse power delivery system **100**) may be configured such that the pulse is controlled to immediately stop. This makes the copper conductor safe to touch, which simplifies installation regulations (e.g., no cable conduit is needed, does not require certified electrician, etc.), and also reduces deployment time and cost.

[0117] Further, unlike AC power, PC power allows centralized power management and distribution, power metering, power backup without the need for cable conduit. Compared to Class 2 DC power (e.g., ESLV Power Supplies, PoE, etc.), PC power is a high voltage Class 4 power (e.g., up to 400V DC) that delivers more power over much longer distance while also having the benefit of using a thinner copper conductor. Some of the benefits of using the thinner copper conductor may include weight savings, cost savings, footprint savings, easier to install, to mention some benefits to thinner wire.

[0118] As described, the pulse power delivery system **100** provides Class 4 PC power by pulsing a high voltage DC (i.e., 300V~600V) on and off for a predefined pulse duration repeatedly in a periodic fashion. Before another high voltage pulse is transmitted, fully redundant and independent fault detection circuitries that utilize discrete hardware will check the transmission line **102** for one or more fault incidents, including, but not necessarily limited to: cable touch or short, cable disconnect, undervoltage, overvoltage, pulse timing skew, or presence of unsafe voltage during the OFF-TIME.

[0119] In addition to the features already described above, the pulse power delivery system **100** may also include features to super impose a low data rate communication signal onto the same transmission line **102** to provide a solution for system management, control, and data reporting for a scalable and manageable PC power distribution system. To implement these features, various techniques and methods may be integrated together to provide an RF (radio frequency) communication link over a high voltage single pair cable for PC applications such as the pulse power delivery system **100**.

[0120] FIG. **18** shows another depiction of the pulse power delivery system **100**, where in FIG. **18** the pulser module **112** is shown transmitting the pulse power signal over the transmission line **102** to the pulse power converter **120**. The pulse power delivery system **100** may include up to 12 pulser modules **112** transmitting over 12 PPP channels over 12 single pair transmission lines **102** in a point-to-point fashion. This enclosed system may be expanded to connect with more enclosed systems under a centralized management point.

[0121] FIG. **19** shows an exemplary pulse power delivery system **1900** that builds upon the architecture of the pulse power delivery system **100**. The interconnection between the pulser module **112** and the pulse power converter **120** may not be limited to the point-to-point connection topology as provided in the pulse power delivery system **100** shown in FIG. **18** but may also be modified to couple multiple pulse power converters **120** in a daisy-chain topology as shown in FIG. **19**. In the exemplary pulse power delivery system **1900**, a single pulser module **112** is configured to drive up to n PPC (Pulse Power Converter) channels to connect to n number of pulse power convertors **120-1** to **120-n**, where n is an integer of 1 or greater. This is made possible by daisy chaining the n number of pulse power converters **120-1** to **120-n** to the common transmission line **102**. Each PPC channel is addressed with a unique address that is assigned at the startup of the pulse power delivery system **1900** over an RF communication link.

[0122] FIG. **20** shows another exemplary pulse power delivery system **2000** that builds upon the architecture of the pulse power delivery system **100**, where the pulse power delivery system **2000**

supports several PPC channels **2001**, **2002**, **2003** that are the outputs from the plurality of unique pulse power convertors **120-1**, **120-2**, **120-n**, where n is an integer of 1 or greater. Each of the pulse power converters **120-1**, **120-2**, **120-n** are supplied their own pulse power signal from a respective pulser module **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-n**. The PPC channels **2001**, **2002**, **2003** are combined into a combined output signal **2004** to support a higher output power. To accomplish the combining of multiple PPC channels **2001**, **2002**, **2003**, the pulse power delivery system **2000** includes an integrated power combiner circuit **2010** that employs n-controlled output switches, n reverse current/polarity blocking/protection controllers, n load sharing controllers, and a sophisticated load startup algorithm. A load device is then configured to connect to the combined output signal **2004**. [0123] FIG. **21** shows a system architecture of an exemplary single channel pulse power system **2100** where the pulser module **112** is directly coupled to the pulse power converter **120** over the single channel transmission line **102**, according to some embodiments. This architecture shown in FIG. **21** incorporates the essential sub-systems that super impose the high-voltage power and RF communication data over the transmission line **102**.

[0124] The pulser module **112** includes a pulser component **2106** (e.g., may be representative of a pulser module and power supply combined), where the pulser component **2106** is configured to take the high-voltage DC power (e.g., $\pm 150\text{V} \sim \pm 200\text{V}$) and chop it up into ON/OFF intervals (e.g., 2 ms ON/1 ms OFF) to produce a train of pulse power on the transmission line **102**. The output of this block is governed by the redundant safety circuitry described herein (e.g., safety circuitry **400**).

[0125] The train generated by the pulser component **2106** is fed into a high-voltage/high-power common-mode rejection filter (CMRF) **2107**. The CMRF **2107** provides close to zero attenuation at the pulse power switching frequency (e.g., 333 Hz) and transitions to a higher attenuation over a wide-band at higher frequencies. The CMRF **2107** is configured to have a peak attenuation of 50 dB at the RF communication carrier frequency. This CMRF **2107** is utilized to prevent any in-band switching harmonics from intermodulating with the modulated RF signal.

[0126] The output of the CMRF **2107** is fed into a high-voltage/high-power, very narrow-band, resonance band-stop filter (BSF) **2108**. The BSF **2108** is constructed of high-power and high voltage resonance inductors and capacitors to provide very high characteristic impedance (notch) at the RF communication carrier frequency and very low impedance otherwise. Without this BSF **2108**, the RF signal would be shunted by electromagnetic interference (EMI) and bulk caps to the left of the BSF **2108**.

[0127] The RF communication signal is a half-duplex signal transmission modulated and demodulated in an RF communication unit **2110**. The input and output of the RF communication unit **2110** is a differential signal that connects to a differential, high-voltage, wide-band, resonance band-pass filter (BPF) **2109**. The BPF **2109** is constructed of high-power and high voltage resonance inductors and X1Y1 capacitors that are used to provide 3 KV reinforced isolation barrier between the primary circuit (HV) and secondary circuit (LV) and to block the DC component such that only the low-voltage, high frequency components in the filter band can be seen by the RF communication unit **2110** RF front-end. Detailed system architecture for the RF communication unit **2110** is depicted in FIG. **21**.

[0128] Circuitry component **2111** and circuitry component **2112** provide the synchronization signal for the RF communication unit **2110** data modulator/coder and demodulator/encoder. The high-voltage pulse current (PC) is first converted into a low-voltage over a resistive network. An X1Y1 capacitor is used to provide 3 KV reinforced isolation between the primary circuit (HV) and secondary circuit (LV) within the circuitry component **2111**. The low-voltage, isolated signal at the output of the circuitry component **2111** represents a logic-level pulse signal that is used to generate a reference signal for the rising and falling edges in the circuitry component **2112** and feeds into the RF communication unit **2110**.

[0129] This RF communication signal at 1 MHz carrier frequency is super imposed into the 333 Hz HV Pulse Current at the transmission line **102**. The 1 MHz carrier frequency was experimentally

selected as the average cable insertion loss up to 1 MHz is acceptable to compensate up to 50 dB attenuation resulted from 2 KM long cable, and in the same time be far away from power switching frequency harmonics that are dominate under 800 KHz.

[0130] The PPC in the transmission line **102** utilizes same architecture/elements for the BSF **2128**, the RF communication unit **2120**, the circuitry component **2121**, and the circuitry component **2122** included in the pulse power converter **120**. A high-voltage/high-power common-mode rejection filter (CMRF) **2123** provides close to zero attenuation at the PP switching frequency (i.e., 333 Hz) and transitions to a higher attenuation over a wide-band at higher frequencies and around the harmonics of the DC-DC phase-shift converter switching frequency in the converter circuitry component **2124**. The CMRF **2123** was designed to have a peak attenuation of 50 dB at the RF communication carrier frequency. This CMRF **2123** is important to prevent any in-band switching harmonics generated by the converter circuitry component **2124** from intermodulation with the RF signal. The converter circuitry component **2124** converts the PC into DC voltage that feeds the DC bus of the phase-shift, full-bridge DC-DC converter. The output of the converter circuitry component **2124** is fed into the load device (e.g., load device **523**). In this way, the RF communication unit **2110** may communicate on the transmission line **102** to be synched to the periods of the pulse power signal by using, among other circuitry components, band-stop, and bandpass filters.

[0131] As mentioned, FIG. **22** illustrates a more detailed system diagram of the components comprising the RF communication unit **2110** sub-system. The RF communication unit **2110** connects with BPF **2109** using bidirectional communication through a differential RF front-end **2201**. A current compensated common-mode rejection filter (CMRF) **2215** blocks the common-mode interference caused by the high-power DC-DC switching converter from getting into the differential RF front-end **2201**. It is designed to provide 10 KQ~15 KQ common-mode impedance and close to zero differential impedance over the RF communication band.

[0132] The RF communication unit **2110** also includes an impedance matching network **2216** that can be tuned to match the transmission line impedance depending on the characteristic impedance of the cable used in the transmission line **102** and the number of multi-drop points connected on the bus in a daisy-chain use case. The impedance matching network **2216** also includes an RF limiter and provides capacitive coupling between the CMRF **2215** and a band-pass filter (BPF) **2217**.

[0133] The BPF **2217** may be an 8th order Butterworth-Bessel 0.5, 200 kHz passband, 1 MHz center frequency, active band-pass filter that is designed to form 40~48 dB in-band attenuation to remove any frequency components that are outside the RF communication signal band over the full range of signal strength (i.e., ± 5 mV to ± 200 mV). The BPF **2217** may be designed to have less than 220 u Vrms noise, 800 n V/VHz spectral noise density at 1 MHz, <7 us group delay, and a fast step response.

[0134] The RF communication unit **2110** may also include an amplifier **2218**, where the amplifier **2218** may be a multi-stage, fully differential input, demodulating logarithmic amplifier that has a very fast voltage mode output. The amplifier **2218** may use a successive detection technique to provide a very high dynamic range. The unique integration of this stage and all the filtering at the front-end allows the pulse power delivery system **100** to provide a demodulated output with up to 50 dB of insertion loss on the cable of the transmission line **102**. The single-ended output from the amplifier **2218** is fed into an RF detector **2219**, where the RF detector **2219** is used to generate a demodulated output represented as an envelope of the input signal after the amplification.

[0135] The demodulated signal from the RF detector **2219** is fed into a self-biased discriminator **2220** that includes a time varying delay to provide dynamic reference to the non-inverting input of the comparator in the pulse power delivery system **100**. The output of the discriminator **2220** is a digitized signal that is fed into a synchronous decoder **2221** that employs a bit-banging algorithm to decode the received data. The decoded data is analyzed and stored afterwards in a memory storage device **2222** (e.g., memory units that may comprise a database).

[0136] For data transmission, the binary data is fed from the memory storage device **2223** (e.g., the memory storage device **2223** may be the same, or different, from the memory storage device **2222**) to an encoder/modulator **2224**. The encoder/modulator **2224** encodes the binary data from the memory storage device **2223** and generates the corresponding baseband frequency (fm) and a carrier frequency (fc) in a digital form. The two outputs from the encoder/modulator **2224** are synchronized to the rising edge of the pulse reference signal received from the circuitry component **2112** before they are fed into a digital inter-modulator **2225**. The output of the digital inter-modulator **2225** is fed next into a uni-directional, differential digital line driver **2226**.

[0137] The RF communication unit **2110** may also include a differential, high-Q, resonance band-pass filter (BPF) **2227**. This BPF **2227** has a narrow band that is tuned to the modulated frequency band. The output of the BPF **2227** is a balanced, CW modulated RF signal that connects to the impedance matching network **2216**. The driving impedance of the transmitter will impose the impedance of the impedance matching network **2216** during data transmission cycles. Meaning, the driving impedance is always fixed and lower than the detection impedance in listening mode. Once the transmission cycle is complete, the line driver will be disabled and the RF communication unit **2110** will be set back to the detection mode impedance (i.e., listening mode).

[0138] FIG. **23** illustrates an exemplary timing graph **2310** showing the timing of the periodic pulse power signal **2312** and the transmission of data packets in a data signal **2311** over the RF communication link. FIG. **23** also illustrates an exemplary data packet **2302** that may be included as part of the data signal **2311** being transmitted over the RF communication link on the transmission line **102**. The data encoding by the encoder/modulator **2224** and the data decoding by the decoder **2221** may be implemented to generate the fixed data packet **2302** as shown in FIG. **23** as follows: [0139] START BITS: Provide a known power-transmission-line (PTL) status and initial identification. [0140] ADDRESS BITS: Identity the remote node in both point-to-point or multi-drop communication link. [0141] Payload: Transmitted Data. [0142] CRC: Data Transmission error-detection.

In the encoding/modulating implemented by the encoder/modulator **24**, the data 8-bit words are mapped to 10-bit symbols to achieve DC balance and bounded disparity, and at the same time provide enough state changes to allow reasonable clock recovery.

[0143] Depending on the characteristic impedance of the cable, whether it's more inductive or capacitive, the ON/OFF transition on the transmission line **102** can create a very low impedance state that shunts the RF signal during that transition for very short time, which will alter the 'high' logic to become 'low' logic for couple bits. This issue is resolved by the present solution by inserting an image of the 10-bit mapped symbols after each 10-bit symbols to provide a simple yet effective way of providing error correction to the data packet **2320**. The image portions of the data bits are depicted in the data packet **2320** by the underline and prime notation.

[0144] The decoding/demodulating stage operated by the decoder **2221** will parse the data and cross each 10-bit symbols with their respective image for error correction. Even if all the bits in the word are altered, the original word can still be recovered. The worst-case scenario occurs when the last 5 bits of the 10-bit symbols and the first 5 bits of the 10-bit symbols image are altered. Yet even in this scenario the original data can still be recovered as the last 5 bits of the 10-bit symbols image are still not altered and can be used to correct the last 5 bits of the 10-bit symbols. This scheme allows bit error correction for an alternation of up to 10 bits. Now if more than 10 bits (i.e., the full word) are corrupted, then the CRC will detect this error, and a data re-transmission will be requested to ensure corrupted data is not mistakenly used.

[0145] The length of the payload can be adjusted based on the ON/OFF Interval. In the data packet **2320** shown in FIG. **23** the data packet structure is for a 2.00 ms ON-Time period and a 1 ms OFF-Time period. In this case, the payload can fit 120 bits that represent 6 data bytes mapped to 10-bit symbols with their corresponding images.

[0146] Whether in a point-to-point topology (see e.g., FIG. **18**) and/or daisy-chain topology (see

e.g., FIG. 19), the pulse power delivery system **100** is only utilizing a single pulser module **112** that switches ON/OFF causing bits alternation to deal with for data error correction. However, when multiple pulser modules **112** are shared for a multi-wire pair cable (e.g., three-pair cable), the crosstalk (e.g., crosstalk due to capacitive coupling) between the pairs may also alter the RF signal during the ON/OFF transition. This becomes a complex problem if the ON/OFF transition of the multiple pulser modules **112** are asynchronous, which can result in more than **10** bits being corrupted, and hence, cannot be restored.

[0147] To overcome this issue, a master clock may be included to provide synchronization between the pulser modules **112** utilizing the same multi-pair cable. In these cases, each pulser module **112** is assigned a slot number. Then based on the slot number, the pulser module **112** will add a phase shift to the master clock to create a trigger for generating the pulse current (PC) to reference the output of the pulser component **2106** for each pulser module **112**.

[0148] FIG. 24 shows an exemplary timing graph **2400** that depicts three pulse current signals (PC signals) **2401**, **2402**, **2403** at the transmission line **102**, with each of the PC current signals **2401-2403** being generated by a first pulser module **241**, a second pulser module, and a third pulser module, respectively. The timing graph **2400** shown in FIG. 24 depicts a scenario where the three pulser modules generating the three PC signals **2401**, **2402**, **2403** are synchronized. Each of the PC signals **2401**, **2402**, **2403** are phase shifted by 120 degrees from each other, which corresponds to a “1 ms delay×slot number” from the master clock. In this case, only two pulser modules are active at the same time (i.e., times when the pulser modules are at logic “high” at the same time). The ON/OFF transition is configured to happen every 1 ms.

[0149] FIG. 25 shows an exemplary timing graph **2500** that depicts nine pulse current signals (PC signals) **2501-2509** at the transmission line **102**, with each of the PC signals **2501-2509** being generated by respective pulser modules. The nine PC signals **2501-2509** being generated by their respective pulser modules are synchronized. For example, each of the nine PC signals **2501-2509** are phase shifted by 40 degrees from each other, which corresponds to a “0.333 ms delay×slot number” from the master clock. In this case, six pulser modules are active at the same time (i.e., times when the pulser modules are at logic “high” at the same time). The ON/OFF transition is shown to happen every 0.333 ms.

[0150] This synchronization strategy for ON/OFF Transition between the several pulser modules has other advantages that include reducing the stress on the main power source, reducing the EMI, and providing a steady power consumption at the system level. For example, utilizing the synchronization strategy minimizes, or at least reduces, the number of pulser modules **112** that need to be turned on at a same time, which in turn reduces the power draw from the power supply that would be demanded at the same time, which reduces the stress on the power supply. Although embodiments having three PC signals (see e.g., FIG. 24) and having nine PC signals (see e.g., FIG. 25), the synchronization strategy may be employed in other embodiments that include a different number of pulser modules generating PC signals for transmission on a multi-pair cable.

[0151] While the particular embodiments described herein have been shown and described, it will be obvious to those skilled in the art that changes and modifications may be made without departing from the teaching of the features described herein. For example, the pulse power delivery system may include different combinations of the components described herein and still be within the scope of this disclosure. Furthermore, although the fault detection, signal smoothing, or error detection features are described as being implemented on the pulser device, according to other embodiments the fault detection, signal smoothing, or error detection features may be implemented as a software-centric solution being executed by the management card. For example, the management card may include a memory storage device configured to store instructions for implementing the fault detection, signal smoothing, or error detection features described herein, as well as a processor for executing the instructions stored on the memory storage device to control the components of the pulse power delivery system to implement the fault detection, signal

smoothing, or error detection features.

[0152] The matter set forth in the foregoing description and accompanying drawings is offered by way of illustration only and not as limitation. The actual scope is intended to be defined in the following claims when viewed in their proper perspective.

Claims

1. A pulser device comprising: a signal shaping component configured to: generate a pulse power signal for transmitting on a transmission line by pulsing a power signal according to a periodic pulsing scheme, wherein a pulse in the pulse power signal comprises: a power delivery portion; and a first signal smoothing portion generated at a falling edge of the pulse following the power delivery portion in the pulse power signal, wherein the first signal smoothing portion corresponds to a plurality of rapid pulses of the power signal for the falling edge of the pulse.
 2. The pulser device of claim 1, wherein a duration of the first signal smoothing portion comprises 2.5% or less of a duration of the pulse.
 3. The pulser device of claim 1, wherein the plurality of rapid pulses to the falling edge of the pulse in the first signal smoothing portion includes a predetermined number of pulses.
 4. The pulser device of claim 3, wherein the predetermined number of pulses includes at least four pulses.
 5. The pulser device of claim 1, wherein the plurality of rapid pulses to the falling edge of the pulse in the first signal smoothing portion lasts for a predetermined length of time.
 6. The pulser device of claim 5, wherein a duration of the pulse lasts for approximately 2 ms and a duration of the plurality of rapid pulses to the falling edge of the pulse in the first signal smoothing portion lasts for approximately 50 μ s.
 7. The pulser device of claim 1, wherein the pulser device is configured to generate the first signal smoothing portion based on a characteristic of the transmission line.
 8. The pulser device of claim 1, wherein the pulse further comprises a second signal smoothing portion generated at a rising edge of the pulse in the pulse power signal.
 9. The pulser device of claim 8, wherein a duration of the second signal smoothing portion comprises 2.5% or less of the pulse.
 10. The pulser device of claim 8, wherein a duration of the second signal smoothing portion and the first signal smoothing portion comprises 5% or less of the pulse.
 11. The pulser device of claim 8, wherein the second signal smoothing portion comprises a plurality of rapid pulses to the rising edge of the pulse.
 12. The pulser device of claim 11, wherein the plurality of rapid pulses to the rising edge of the pulse includes a predetermined number of pulses.
 13. The pulser device of claim 12, wherein the predetermined number of pulses includes at least four pulses.
 14. The pulser device of claim 9 wherein a duration of the plurality of rapid pulses to the rising edge of the pulse lasts for a predetermined length of time.
 15. The pulser device of claim 14, wherein a duration of the pulse lasts for approximately 2 ms and the plurality of rapid pulses to the rising edge of the pulse that comprise the second signal smoothing portion lasts for approximately 50 μ s.
 16. The pulser device of claim 9, wherein the pulser device is configured to generate the second signal smoothing portion based on a characteristic of the transmission line.
 17. The pulser device of claim 1, wherein the signal shaping component comprises an inductor-capacitor LC filter and a free-wheel diode.
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